What this workbook covers 本册讲什么

This chapter is about one study and three variations of it. Milgram wanted to know whether **ordinary people would obey an order to hurt a stranger**. Everything in this booklet either describes that study, or evaluates it, or asks what happens when you take one piece of the situation away.

How to use this booklet 怎么用

1. **Fill it in as you go.** Do not read it like a textbook. Write the word in the blank before you check the answer key.
2. **The answer key is at the back (pp. 18–19).** Cover it. Check after each page, and tick the tracker below.
3. **Pages 15 and 17–18 are exam pages.** Do them last, from memory, under time.

Content map 内容地图

Page	Topic	What you must be able to do afterwards
p.2	Foundations 背景与两个易混词	Say why Milgram ran the study; separate obedience from conformity
p.3	The baseline procedure 基线程序	Describe the seven steps in order — this is a 4-mark answer
p.4	The machine and the script 机器与台词	Give the three machine numbers and the learner's key voltages
p.5	The four prods 四句催促	Write the four prods in order, and say what they are NOT
p.6	Results 结果数字	Quote 100% / 65% / 35% with what each one means
p.7	Ethics 伦理	Fill the four-issue table and know Milgram's defence for each
p.8–9	Evaluation 评价	Four strengths and six limitations, each with a consequence
p.10	The three supports 权威的三条腿	Name presence / prestige / legitimacy and which study removes which
p.11–13	Experiments 7, 10, 13	Variation, result figure, and the conclusion it supports
p.14	Side by side 四组对照	Write the whole comparison table and explain dissent
p.15	Every number 数字收口	Cover the right column and test yourself
p.16	Exam skills 答题技巧	Command words, mark allocation, sentence frames
p.17–18	Practice A & B 演练	Short answers, then the 8-mark essay
p.18–19	Answer key 答案速查	Mark honestly, then re-write wrong answers in full

Revision tracker 复习打卡

☐ p.2–6 baseline ☐ p.7 ethics ☐ p.8–9 evaluation ☐ p.10–13 variations ☐ p.14–15 comparison ☐ p.16–18 exam

The whole chapter in one sentence 全章一句话

Ordinary people obeyed — **65% went to 450 V** — not because they were cruel, but because the **situation** supported the authority figure; when Milgram removed that support one piece at a time (telephone 20.5%, rundown office 47.5%, ordinary man 20%), obedience fell every single time.

§1 · Foundations — why Milgram ran it, and two words you must not mix up

ANSWERS → p.18

Background: the question behind the study

Stanley Milgram was a social psychologist at _____ University. He began the study in _____, sixteen years after the end of the Second World War. (his workplace / the year)

At the Nuremberg trials, Nazi officers accused of mass murder used the same defence: "_____". The world's answer was that these men must have been unusually cruel or mentally ill. (four words you will meet again in 1.1.1)

Milgram was testing a different idea: that ordinary, mentally healthy people would obey, and that the cause lay in the _____ rather than in their _____. (two nouns: 情境 / 人格)

Two words students lose marks on

Term	Definition 定义（背原文）	Why it matters here
obedience 服从	Following a _____ _____ from someone perceived to have _____.	In Milgram there is one man giving one order.
conformity 从众	Changing your behaviour to match a _____ or _____ — no order is given.	Covered in 1.1.4–1.1.7. Not this chapter.

中文理解：为什么这个区分决定整章?
如果服从来自**人格**，那只有"某种人"才会做坏事，Milgram 的实验就没什么好讲的。
如果服从来自**情境**，那么任何人都可能——只要情境对。Milgram 的三个变式实验就是为了证明第二种：他不停地**改情境**，看服从会不会跟着变。
所以考试里问 "describe" 你要写程序，问 "evaluate" 你要落到**情境 vs 人格**这个争论。

Quick check 自查

1. In one sentence, what was Milgram trying to find out? （写一行英文）

2. Circle the correct word: Milgram's participants were told the study was about **memory and learning / punishment and aggression**.

3. Why does Milgram's study count as obedience and not conformity? （中文即可）

§2 · The baseline procedure — the seven steps

ANSWERS → p.18

In order, these seven steps are a complete 4-mark "describe" answer. Fill the missing words.

#	Stage	What happened
1	Recruitment	A _____ advert in the New Haven area; ____ men aged 20–50; paid $____ for turning up.
2	The setting	A laboratory at Yale. The _____ story was a study of memory and learning.
3	The draw	A rigged draw — _____ slips said “teacher”, so the real participant was always the teacher.
4	Set-up	The learner was strapped to a chair, and the teacher was given a real ____ V sample shock.
5	The task	The teacher read _____ pairs; the learner picked from four options.
6	The rule	Every wrong answer: one switch higher, +____ V each time.
7	The pressure	If the teacher hesitated, the experimenter used ____ standard prods.
then	Debriefing	The truth was explained, and the teacher was reunited with the unharmed “learner”.

Four details examiners look for 阅卷老师找的四点

- ____ male participants from the _____ area, recruited by newspaper advert.
- The learner was a _____ — an actor named Mr Wallace. He received _____ shocks at all.
- The draw was _____, which makes the procedure _____ (欺骗).
- The experimenter wore a grey _____ and gave no threats and no rewards — only _____ prods.

最常见的三个丢分点

① 把 “40 participants” 写成 “20” —— 20 是 Experiment 13 的人数，基线是 **40**。
② 写 “Milgram 命令并威胁他们” —— 没有。四个 prods 里没有一句是威胁，也没有惩罚。
③ 写 “他们不能离开” —— 能离开。门没锁，钱已经到手，**40 人里有 14 个真的停了**。

Write it out 默写

Close this page. In four sentences, describe Milgram's baseline procedure. Include: who was recruited · the roles · the task and voltages · the prods.

§3 · The shock machine and the learner's script

ANSWERS → p.18

The machine — three numbers you must not get wrong

The generator had ____ switches, from ____ V up to ____ V, in ____ V steps. The switches were not just numbers — they carried written _____, so participants knew how serious each level was meant to be. (开关数 / 起始 / 上限 / 每档 / 标签)

Voltage range	Label on the panel	Why it matters
15–60 V	_____ shock	Participants were given a real 45 V sample so the machine felt genuine.
75–120 V	Moderate shock	The learner begins to grunt and then complains.
135–180 V	_____ shock	He demands to be released — the first clear refusal.
195–240 V	Very strong shock	Screaming begins.
255–300 V	_____ shock	300 V: he bangs on the wall and then stops responding.
315–360 V	Extreme intensity shock	Silence from the learner — no answer, no protest.
375–420 V	Danger: severe shock	Continuing past this point is continuing against a written warning.
435–450 V	_____	The top of the scale — and the number in the results.

The learner's script — same for every participant

The reactions were _____, so every participant heard exactly the same thing at exactly the same voltages. That is what makes this a controlled comparison.

Voltage	What the teacher heard
75 V	A grunt.
120 V	Shouts that the shocks were becoming _____.
150 V	"Get me out of here! I refuse to go on. My _____ is starting to bother me."
180 V	"I can't stand the pain!"
270 V	An agonised scream.
300 V	Refuses to answer; bangs on the wall.
_____ V onward	Silence. No answers and no further protests.

中文理解：为什么"沉默"比"尖叫"更可怕

尖叫至少说明那个人**活着、在反应**。300 伏之后什么都没有了——参与者完全不知道隔壁是晕过去了，还是更糟。考试里写这个细节，说明参与者是在**极大的不确定和不安**下继续按开关，而不是因为麻木或冷血。

§4–5 · The four prods · the results · moral strain

ANSWERS → p.18

The four prods — write them in order

#	The prod	What is doing the work
1	“Please continue.” / “Please go on.”	A polite request.
2	“_____”	The study needs it — not the man personally.
3	“_____”	Escalation, but still no threat.
4	“_____”	The strongest prod. After this, refusal ended the session.

Read the four sentences again: not one of them is a _____. No “or I will call the police”, no money off. (noun)

The results — five numbers

Figure	What it means	Why you quote it
_____ %	Every one of the 40 reached at least _____ V.	Nobody stopped early once the learner was silent.
_____ %	_____ of the 40 went to the very top, 450 V.	The headline number. Write “26 of 40” as well.
_____ %	_____ participants refused (5 stopped at 300 V, 4 at 315 V).	Proves they *could* withdraw — the pressure was verbal.
_____ **V**	The mean maximum shock delivered.	Well into the “danger” zone — not a marginal effect.
_____ %	What the 40 psychiatrists predicted would reach 450 V.	Experts underestimated the power of the situation.

Moral strain 道德压力

_____ — the distress a person feels when what they are told to do clashes with what they believe is right. (the English term)

Signs Milgram observed 观察到的表现（写中文即可）

· _____、_____、_____（三个生理反应）
· biting their lips until they _____ · digging their fingernails into their own flesh
· nervous _____ fits · _____ participants had full-blown, uncontrollable seizures

Why this detail wins marks

If participants had calmly pressed to the end, the conclusion would be “some people are born cruel”. Instead they sweated, trembled and bit their lips — they did **not want to continue but could not stop**. That is what moral strain names, and it is the reason Milgram argued the behaviour came from the situation, not from sadism.

§6–7 · Did they believe it? · was it ethical?

ANSWERS → p.18

Demand characteristics 需求特征

_____ and _____ (1968) argued participants did not really believe the shocks were real — so their behaviour was not obedience at all, it was going along with what they thought the researcher wanted. That is _____: cues in a study that tell people what is expected. (two surnames / year / the English term)

Evidence they DID believe

- Unmistakable distress — trembling, sweating, three _____.
- In post-experiment interviews, _____ said they believed the shocks were real.
- ____% were glad to have taken part; only about ____% regretted it.
- A follow-up _____ later found no lasting psychological harm.

Evidence some did NOT

- _____ (2013) re-analysed Milgram's archived tape recordings.
- A number of participants openly _____ whether the shocks were real *during* the session.
- Some hesitated in ways that suggest they were _____ the experimenter rather than obeying him.

中文理解：怎么答才不偏?

不要只写“研究无效”或“研究完全真实”。最好的写法是**两边都写，再给判断**：
“批评者认为参与者看穿了（Orne & Holland 1968），但参与者的痛苦反应和事后访谈支持他们相信了电击；Perry (2013) 重新听录音后发现部分人确实怀疑过——因此这个争议**到今天没有完全解决**。”

Was it ethical? — four issues

Ethical issue	What happened	Milgram's defence / how it was handled
Deception 欺骗	The draw was fixed; the learner was an actor; the _____ were fake.	Deception was _____ — without it there is no obedience to study.
Informed consent 知情同意	Participants did not know the real _____ and could not truly consent.	_____ consent: other people were asked whether they would agree.
Right to withdraw 退出权	The prods made stopping feel _____.	Participants could leave, and ____ of them did.
Protection from harm	Severe distress; ____ seizures.	Full debriefing, a reunion with Mr Wallace, and a _____ follow-up.

Exam habit 答题习惯

A single ethical point on its own scores almost nothing. Always add **why it matters**: “The deception means we cannot be certain participants were responding to real obedience rather than _____, which _____ the conclusion.”

§8 · Evaluating Milgram — strengths

ANSWERS → p.18

A strength is worth one mark only if you say **what it is** and **why it matters for the conclusion**. Fill the "consequence" column.

Strength	What the point is	Consequence 它说明什么 / 带来什么好处
CONTROL **高度控制**	A _____ experiment with a standardised script — every participant heard the same protests at the same voltages.	_____
REPLICATION **可重复**	_____ (2009) replicated a modified version and found ____% continued at 150 V, close to Milgram's 82% at the same point.	_____
CULTURE **跨文化**	_____ (1999) analysed replications in several countries outside the USA and found obedience rates broadly similar.	_____
INTERNAL VALIDITY **内部效度**	The variations change _____ feature at a time.	_____

The sentence frame you can reuse 万能句式

"A strength is **[point]**. This matters because **[why]**, which means **[what we can conclude]**."

Turn each strength into a sentence 练一句

1 · Burger (2009):

2 · Blass (1999):

Numbers to carry into any evaluation answer

Burger (2009) **70%** at 150 V vs Milgram's **82%** · Blass (1999) similar rates across several countries · baseline **65%** to 450 V · the three variations **20.5% / 47.5% / 20%**.
A quotation with a number and a name always beats "some research shows…".

Self-check 自查

Which single strength best answers the criticism "the study is fifty years old and would not happen now"? Why?

§9 · Evaluating Milgram — limitations

ANSWERS → p.18

Six limitations. For each, write **what it is** and **what it does to the conclusion**.

Limitation	What the point is	Consequence 对结论做了什么
ETHICS 伦理	Deception, no informed consent, pressure against withdrawal, severe distress and ____ seizures. _____ (1964) argued the costs were unacceptable.	_____
ECOLOGICAL VALIDITY 生态效度	Pressing switches on a machine in a _____ is not the same as carrying out orders in a real institution.	_____
SAMPLE 样本	____ American men, all volunteers from one city, recruited by advert and paid $4.50.	_____
DEMAND 需求特征	_____ argued they were play-acting; _____ (2013) found archive recordings of doubts.	_____
INTERPRETATION 另一种解释	_____ re-examined Milgram's own data and argued participants obeyed because they _____ with the scientific goals.	_____
GENERALISABILITY 推广性	The task is electric shocks on a stranger — very different from bureaucratic harm or wartime obedience.	_____

不要列清单，要写"所以呢"

差：“The sample was small and all male.”（1 分上限）

好：“Because the sample was 40 male volunteers we cannot generalise the 65% figure to women, which limits any claim that *everyone* would obey.”（真正的 AO3）

Balance it 收口

In two sentences: does the situational conclusion survive these criticisms, or not? Give a judgement and one reason.

§10 · The plan behind the variations — the three supports

ANSWERS → p.18

Milgram ran more than ____ variations of the same basic procedure. The specification asks you to know three: **Experiments 7, 10 and 13**.

中文理解：这一节是整章的骨架——先建立坐标

别把三个变式当成三个独立的故事去背。它们是**同一个实验，每次拆掉一样东西**：

权威靠**三条腿**站着——在不在场（_____）、有没有名望（_____）、是不是真权威（_____）。

Milgram 一次抽掉一条腿，看服从会不会塌。(three English terms)

Match each variation to what it removes

Study	What changed	Situational factor removed
Experiment 7	The experimenter left the room and gave orders _____ from another room.	_____
Experiment 10	Moved out of Yale into a _____ office block, under a made-up name.	_____
Experiment 13	An "ordinary man" — a _____ pretending to be another participant — took over.	_____

Write the results now 趁热

Study	Obedience to 450 V	Fraction out of participants
Baseline (1963)	_____%	_____ of 40
Experiment 7	_____%	9 of 40
Experiment 10	_____%	19 of 40
Experiment 13	_____%	4 of ____

The one sentence that decides the chapter

In all three variations the participants were the _____ kind of people, recruited the same way, doing the same task on the same machine. Only the _____ changed — and obedience changed with it. (same / what changed)

Why this matters for 1.1.1

The agency theory in 1.1.1 says entering the agentic state requires a legitimate authority figure. These three variations are the evidence for that claim: remove presence, prestige or legitimacy, and people switch back to acting on their own conscience.

§11 · Experiment 7 · telephonic instructions

ANSWERS → p.18

What changed

The experimenter left the room and gave his orders over a _____ from another room. Everything else — the machine, the learner, the prods — stayed _____. There were ____ participants.

Result

Only _____% — about ____ of the 40 — went all the way to 450 V, down from _____% in the baseline.

Something else happened — and it is excellent evidence

Several participants _____: they gave shocks _____ than they were told to, or claimed to be following instructions when they were not.

> **中文理解：作弊行为反而证明了结论**
> 当实验者**看不见**他们在做什么时，很多人偷偷**不按要求**按——说明他们**在乎**学习者，只是不敢当面违抗。
> 考试里这是一条很漂亮的证据：它说明参与者不是冷血，而是**被在场的人压住了**。权威一走，他们的真实想法立刻回来了。

What it shows

Take the authority figure out of the room and obedience drops by roughly _____ — even though the words spoken are identical.

Exam sentence 背这一句

Fill the gaps, then memorise: “In _____ the experimenter gave his orders by telephone, and obedience fell from _____% to _____%, showing that _____ is a powerful situational factor.”

Compare the size of the drop

Support removed	Obedience	Drop from baseline (percentage points)
None — baseline	65%	—
Presence (Exp 7)	20.5%	_____ points
Prestige (Exp 10)	47.5%	_____ points

Removing the authority's *body* cost more than twice as much as removing the university's *name*.

Your turn 练笔

Explain one finding from Milgram's variation studies. (2 marks — one point + one reason.)

§12 · Experiment 10 · the rundown office block

ANSWERS → p.18

What changed

The whole study moved out of _____. It was run in a rundown office block in _____, Connecticut, under the made-up name "_____" — with no university connection at all. There were ____ participants.

Result

_____% — ____ of the 40 — still went to 450 V. Lower than Yale's 65%, but far _____ than the drop seen in Experiment 7.

The comparison that matters

Removing…	Obedience	Cost in percentage points
the authority's presence	20.5%	_____
the university's prestige	47.5%	_____

What it shows

Prestige _____, but much less than presence. Nearly _____ still obeyed a stranger in a shabby office.

> **Do not over-read this one 别过度解读**
> The tempting wrong conclusion is "people only obeyed because it was Yale". The data says otherwise: **47.5% still obeyed with Yale's name completely removed**. The honest conclusion is that prestige **contributes but does not create** obedience.

Use it to answer a criticism 用这条反驳别人

Someone says: "Milgram's findings were just an artefact of Yale's prestige." Write two sentences back, using the 47.5% figure.

中文理解

想象一下：你在一栋破旧写字楼里，一个自称"Bridgeport 研究协会"的人让你电击陌生人。近一半人还是照做了。
这说明服从**不是耶鲁的招牌造出来的**——评价题里这是反驳"名校光环论"的那一张牌。

Spot the difference 三个变式对比填空

Study	Participants	What was removed	Obedience
Experiment 7	40	_____	20.5%
Experiment 10	40	Prestige of the institution	_____%
Experiment 13	____	_____	_____%

§13 · Experiment 13 · the ordinary man gives orders

ANSWERS → p.18

What changed

The experimenter was called away on a pretended _____. An "ordinary man" — a _____ pretending to be another participant — then took over and suggested raising the shock by ____ V after each wrong answer. There were ____ participants.

No uniform, no lab coat, no _____ position. (what he lacked)

Result

Only _____% — ____ of the 20 — obeyed fully. This is the _____ of the three variations.

Typical response

Many used the _____ possible shocks, _____ with him, or went through the motions without really following his suggestions.

What it shows

Obedience depends on _____ — who is seen as entitled to give orders. The same words from someone with no authority have very little power.

中文理解：最贴近"我不是听你的，我是听那个位置的"
"普通人"说的**话完全一样**，但他没有制服、没有头衔、不代表任何机构。结果：几乎没人听他的。
这说明服从的对象是**那个被认可的权威身份**，而不是任何一张嘴。

Exam sentence 背这一句

"When an ordinary man gave the _____ (Experiment 13), obedience fell to _____%, showing that obedience depends on the _____ of the person giving them."

Apply it 迁移题

Each scenario below removes one support. Write which support (presence / prestige / legitimacy) each one removes — and say whether you would expect obedience to fall to about 20%, about 47% or stay near 65%.

Scenario	Support removed	Expected obedience
A prison officer delivers a reprimand by loudspeaker from the control room instead of standing in front of the prisoner. Compliance drops.	_____	about _____%
The same training course is delivered by a world-famous university instead of an unknown local college. Attendees follow instructions far more closely.	_____	about _____%
A passenger with no uniform or badge starts directing traffic during a power cut. Almost nobody follows him.	_____	about _____%

§14 · Side by side, and what they prove about dissent

ANSWERS → p.18

The complete comparison table 四组对照（背这张表）

Study	What was changed	Obedience to 450 V	Situational factor removed
Baseline (1963)	Nothing — the reference point	_____	—
Experiment 10	Rundown office block, no Yale name	_____	_____
Experiment 7	Orders given by telephone	_____	_____
Experiment 13	An ordinary man gives the orders	_____	_____

Order them 从高到低排序

65% · 47.5% · 20.5% · 20% → highest first: _____

dissent（不从 / 抗拒）

_____ — refusing to obey an order or resisting the pressure to continue. The specification asks you to treat these three variations as evidence about the _____ factors that encourage dissent.

中文理解：把三个变式收成一句话
权威的"三条腿"被抽掉任何一条，服从就下降；因此**鼓励 dissent 的方法就是削弱这些情境因素**：
让权威**不在场**（Exp 7）、**去掉机构的名望**（Exp 10）、**让下令的人没有合法性**（Exp 13）。

Key terms for this chapter 本章术语

Term	Definition
obedience 服从	Following a direct order from someone perceived to have authority.
conformity 从众	Changing behaviour to match a majority — no order is given.
dissent 不从 / 抗拒	_____
moral strain 道德压力	_____
confederate 同谋者	An actor working for the researcher — in Milgram's study, Mr Wallace.
demand characteristics	_____
presumptive consent 推定同意	_____
androcentric 男性中心	_____

§15 · Every number on one page

Cover the right column and test yourself

Clue	Answer
Participants in the baseline study	40 men, 20–50 yrs, New Haven
How they were recruited / paid	Newspaper advert; $4.50
Real sample shock given to the teacher	45 V
Number of switches on the generator	30
Size of each voltage step	15 V
Top voltage on the machine	450 V (labelled XXX)
Number of standard prods	4
Reached 300 V	100% (all 40)
Reached 450 V (baseline)	65% — 26 of 40
Defied / withdrew	35% — 14 of 40 (5 at 300 V, 4 at 315 V)
Mean maximum shock delivered	about 368 V
Psychiatrists' prediction of the 450 V rate	1.2% (about 1 in 1000)
Participants who had seizures	3
Glad to have taken part · regretted it	84% · about 1%
Experiment 7 — change and result	Telephone; 20.5% (9 of 40)
Experiment 10 — change and result	Rundown Bridgeport office; 47.5% (19 of 40)
Experiment 13 — change and result	Ordinary man gives orders; 20% (4 of 20)
Cost of removing presence / prestige	44.5 points / 17.5 points
Burger (2009) replication at 150 V	70% (Milgram: 82%)
Blass (1999) — what kind of study	Analysis of replications across several countries

Self-test routine

Fold this page so only the left column shows. Say the answer out loud before moving down. Mark any row you cannot answer, then re-learn only those rows.

Names to have ready

Orne and Holland (1968) · Perry (2013) · Burger (2009) · Blass (1999) · Baumrind (1964) · Haslam, Reicher and Birney (2014).
Write one line for each — what they did and whether they support or attack Milgram:

§16 · Exam skills — command words, marks, sentence frames

USE WITH pp. 16–17

Command words 指令词

Word	What it wants	What NOT to do
Describe	Who, where, what they did, and the key **numbers**. Pure AO1.	Do not evaluate or give opinions.
Explain	Give reasons or mechanisms — one point plus one reason per mark.	Do not just restate the finding.
Evaluate	Strengths *and* limitations, each with a consequence, plus a conclusion.	Do not produce a list of criticisms.

How many marks, how much writing

Marks	Typical demand	Time
2	Two separate points, each developed once.	2–3 min
4	Four developed points, or two points plus two elaborations.	5 min
8	Half AO1 (accurate description), half AO3 (judgement and evidence). Four paragraphs.	10–12 min

Sentence frames 万能句式（可直接套）

Describe: “Milgram recruited … through …, telling them the study was about … . Each participant was assigned …, while a confederate played … . … increasing the shock by … each time, from … up to … .”

Explain a variation: “One situational factor is … . In Experiment … the … , and obedience fell from …% to …% . Because nothing else changed, the drop shows that … .”

Evaluate: “A strength/limitation is … . This matters because … , which means we cannot … / which strengthens … .”

Marking habit 加分习惯

Every time you mention a study, you need a **name**, a **year** and ideally a **number**. “Some research shows obedience is high” scores 0. “Burger (2009) found 70% still continued at 150 V” scores.

Common mistakes checklist 常见错误清单

☐ 混淆 obedience 和 conformity ☐ 把 40 写成 20（那是 Exp 13）

☐ 写电击是真的（只有 45 V 样品是真的） ☐ 写“他们无法离开”（14 人离开了）

☐ 把 hierarchy / legitimacy of authority（1.1.1）和 affiliation（1.1.3）混进来

☐ 评价题只列批评不给“影响” ☐ 引研究不给数字

Plan your own 8-mark answer here 先写框架

§17 · exam Practice A — short answers

Model answers → p.19

Amara took part in a study that she was told was about memory and learning. She was told to give the learner an electric shock whenever he made a mistake, increasing the shock each time. When she hesitated, the researcher said "the experiment requires that you continue". The study took place in a laboratory at a well-known university.

Q1 — From the description, identify TWO features that suggest this is based on Milgram's research. (2 marks)

Q2 — Describe Milgram's (1963) research into obedience. (4 marks)

Four developed points: who was recruited · the roles and how they were assigned · the task and voltages · the prods and results.

Q3 — Explain what is meant by "moral strain", and give one piece of evidence from Milgram's study. (2 marks)

One mark for the definition, one for the evidence — give several details, not just one word.

Q4 — From Milgram's variation studies, explain ONE situational factor that encourages dissent. (2 marks)

Name the factor · name the experiment and the two numbers · say why changes in the situation explain the change in obedience.

Q5 — Milgram asked 40 psychiatrists to predict how far participants would go. Explain why this detail is useful when evaluating the study. (3 marks)

Three points: what they predicted · how it compares with 65% · what that gap tells us about explanations of obedience.

§18 · exam Practice B — the 8-mark essay + brain dump

Model answer → p.19

Q6 — Evaluate Milgram's (1963) research into obedience. (8 marks)

Half the marks for accurate content, half for judgement with evidence. Plan four paragraphs first.

¶	Job of that paragraph 内容	My points 我的要点
1	**Method:** standardised laboratory procedure — and why that is both a strength and a limitation.	
2	**Ethics:** deception, consent, distress — and what the deception does to the conclusion.	
3	**Sample and validity:** 40 male volunteers; androcentric, ethnocentric, ecological validity.	
4	**Conclusion:** alternative explanations and replications; say whether the conclusion survives.	

Brain dump — close the book 合上笔记盲测

Ten minutes. Write everything you can remember about this chapter, from memory only: the procedure, the three key result numbers, the three variations with their figures, two strengths and two limitations — with named researchers.

pp.2–3 — Foundations and procedure

Background: Yale; 1961; “I was only following orders”; situation; personality.
obedience: direct order; authority. conformity: majority; group.
Procedure: newspaper; 40; $4.50; cover; both; 45; word; 15; four; then debriefing.
Details: 40 male; New Haven; confederate; no; fixed; deception; lab coat; verbal.

pp.4–5 — Machine, script, prods, results, moral strain

Machine: 30 switches; 15 V; 450 V; 15 V steps; labels. Labels: Slight; Strong; Intense; XXX.
Script: scripted; painful; heart; 315 V onward (silence begins after 300 V — the last answer heard was at 300 V).
Prods: “The experiment requires that you continue.” · “It is absolutely essential that you continue.” · “You have no other choice, you must go on.” None is a threat.
Results: 100% reached 300 V · 65% = 26 of 40 reached 450 V · 35% = 14 defied (5 at 300 V, 4 at 315 V) · mean maximum about 368 V · psychiatrists predicted 1.2%.
Moral strain: sweating, trembling, stuttering; bled; laughing; three participants had seizures.

p.6 — Did they believe it? Ethics

Orne and Holland (1968); demand characteristics. Evidence for: seizures; most; 84% glad, about 1% regretted; one year later. Evidence against: Perry (2013); questioned; testing.
Ethics table: shocks; necessary; aim; presumptive; difficult; 14; three; one-year. Exam habit: demand characteristics; weakens/undermines.

pp.7–8 — Evaluation

Strengths. CONTROL: laboratory — comparisons across participants and variations are meaningful, and the study is replicable. REPLICATION: Burger (2009), 70% — the effect has not disappeared with time. CULTURE: Blass (1999) — the finding is not uniquely American. INTERNAL VALIDITY: one — each variation isolates the feature that is doing the work.

Limitations. ETHICS: three; Baumrind — raises the question of whether the knowledge was worth the distress, and the deception threatens the validity of the finding itself. ECOLOGICAL: laboratory — findings may not generalise to real institutions or real-world atrocities. SAMPLE: 40 — androcentric and culturally narrow, so the 65% cannot be generalised to women. DEMAND: Orne and Holland (1968); Perry (2013) — participants may have been responding to cues rather than obeying. INTERPRETATION: Haslam, Reicher and Birney (2014); identified — offers a non-situational explanation of the same behaviour. GENERALISABILITY: the task is artificial, so the conclusion should be limited to laboratory obedience.

pp.9–12 — The variations

Thirty; presence; prestige; legitimacy.
Match: Exp 7 telephone → presence. Exp 10 rundown office → prestige. Exp 13 ordinary man (confederate) → legitimacy.
Results: Baseline 65% (26 of 40) · Exp 7 20.5% (9 of 40) · Exp 10 47.5% (19 of 40) · Exp 13 20% (4 of 20).
Exp 7: telephone; exactly the same; 40 participants; 20.5%; 9; 65%; cheated; smaller; two thirds; physical presence of the authority.
Exp 10: Yale; Bridgeport; “Research Associates of Bridgeport”; 40; 47.5%; 19; higher (far less than Exp 7); 44.5; 17.5; matters; half; contributes but does not create.
Exp 13: telephone call; confederate; 15 V; 20 participants; recognised; 20%; 4; lowest; lowest; argued; who is seen as entitled to give orders; Experiment 13; orders; 20%; legitimacy.
Apply it: presence ≈ 20% · prestige ≈ 47% (the example given is the reverse direction — a famous university raises obedience toward 65%) · legitimacy ≈ 20%.

p.13 — Side by side and key terms

Table: 65% (26 of 40) · 47.5% (19 of 40) prestige of the institution · 20.5% (9 of 40) physical presence · 20% (4 of 20) legitimacy of the authority.
Highest first: 65% → 47.5% → 20.5% → 20%.
dissent: refusing to obey an order or resisting the pressure to continue; situational.
Key terms: dissent — refusing to obey or resisting pressure to continue. moral strain — distress from the clash between obeying an order and not wanting to cause harm. demand characteristics — cues that tell participants what is expected. presumptive consent — asking a similar group whether they would consent. androcentric — based on men only, so findings may not apply to women.

p.16 — Q1 model (2 marks)

① The participant is deceived into believing the study is about **memory and learning**, and is ordered to give electric shocks that increase with each mistake. ② The researcher responds to hesitation with the standard prod **"the experiment requires that you continue"**, and the setting includes a laboratory at a prestigious institution — all three are features of Milgram's baseline study.

p.16 — Q2 model (4 marks)

Milgram recruited **40 male participants** through a newspaper advert, telling them the study was about **memory and learning**. At a **Yale** laboratory each participant was given the role of **teacher** through a rigged draw, while a confederate played the learner. The teacher read word pairs and gave the learner an electric shock for every wrong answer, **increasing it by 15 V each time from 15 V up to 450 V**. If the teacher hesitated the experimenter used one of **four standard prods**, such as "the experiment requires that you continue". **100% reached 300 V and 65% continued to 450 V**.

p.16 — Q3 model (2 marks)

Moral strain is the distress a person experiences when following an order conflicts with their own judgement about what is right. In Milgram's study participants showed it through **sweating, trembling, stuttering, nervous laughter and biting their lips until they bled**, and **three participants had full-blown seizures** — showing they continued while deeply uncomfortable rather than obeying calmly.

p.16 — Q4 model (2 marks)

One situational factor is the **physical presence of the authority figure**. In Experiment 7 the experimenter gave his orders by telephone instead of standing in the room, and obedience fell from **65% to 20.5%**. Because nothing else changed, the drop shows that removing the authority's presence makes dissent far more likely — people are much readier to refuse someone they do not have to face.
Alternative: legitimacy — Experiment 13, ordinary man gave the orders, obedience fell to 20% (4 of 20). *Or:* prestige — Experiment 10, rundown office block in Bridgeport, 47.5% still obeyed, so prestige contributes but is much weaker than presence.

p.16 — Q5 model (3 marks)

① Milgram described the procedure to **40 psychiatrists**, who predicted that only about **1.2%** — roughly one person in a thousand — would go to 450 V. ② In fact **65% (26 of 40)** did. ③ The huge gap matters because even experts who study disturbed behaviour assumed obedience requires an unusual personality; the result supports Milgram's **situational** explanation and shows how poorly people predict the power of the situation — which is exactly why the finding is important.

p.17 — Q6 model (8 marks)

¶1 Method. A strength is that the procedure was highly standardised: every participant heard the same protests at the same voltages and faced the same four prods, so the study is replicable and the variations are genuinely comparable. However, this control was bought at the cost of **ecological validity** — pressing switches in a laboratory is not the same as carrying out orders inside a real institution.

¶2 Ethics. Participants were deceived about the aim, the draw and the shocks, could not give informed consent, and were pressured not to withdraw; several showed extreme distress and **three had seizures**. This matters beyond welfare: the deception means we cannot be sure participants were showing real obedience rather than responding to **demand characteristics**, as **Orne and Holland (1968)** argued. Milgram replied that participants were distressed precisely because they believed it — and **84% later said they were glad to have taken part**.

¶3 Sample and validity. 40 male volunteers from one American city, recruited by advert and paid $4.50 — **androcentric** and culturally narrow, so the 65% figure cannot be generalised to women. **Blass (1999)** partly answers this, finding broadly similar rates in replications outside the USA.

¶4 Conclusion. The conclusion is contested: **Haslam, Reicher and Birney (2014)** argue participants obeyed because they identified with the scientific goals rather than because they abandoned their conscience. Yet **Burger (2009)** found **70% still continued at 150 V** decades later, and all three variations show obedience shifting with the situation alone. On balance the situational explanation is well supported for the laboratory task, but should not be stretched to explain real-world atrocities on its own.

Final check — what you must be able to write without looking

The ten things 十件事

1. Why Milgram ran the study — Nuremberg, “I was only following orders”, situation vs personality.
2. Four for the baseline: **40 men · $4.50 · Yale · cover story memory and learning**.
3. The roles: rigged draw → always teacher; **confederate** Mr Wallace; fake shocks but a real **45 V** sample.
4. The machine: **30 switches, 15 V steps, up to 450 V**, written labels including XXX.
5. The four prods in order — none of them is a threat or a punishment.
6. Three numbers: **100% to 300 V · 65% (26/40) to 450 V · 35% (14/40) defied**.
7. **Moral strain** and the observed signs, including three seizures.
8. Two named criticisms with years: **Orne and Holland (1968)**, **Perry (2013)**.
9. Two named defences with figures: **Burger (2009) 70%**, **Blass (1999)**.
0. All three variations: what was removed, the percentages, and what each supports about **dissent**.

The three variations in one table — write it from memory

Study	Removed	Obedience	Conclusion
Baseline	nothing		
Exp 7			
Exp 10			
Exp 13			

What is still shaky 还不熟的地方

Write down only the things you got wrong when checking this booklet. Come back to just these lines before the exam.

下一步 Next

This chapter sits between two others in the specification. **1.1.1** gives the theories that explain *why* people obey — agency theory and legitimacy of authority. **1.1.3** looks at further situational factors: proximity, location and uniform, plus dispositional factors such as personality and gender. Milgram's variations are evidence for both of them.